

Leave Policy

Company: Northwind Digital (fictional demo company)

Policy owner: People Operations. Applies to all full-time employees globally. This document describes the fictional leave entitlements used to demonstrate the HR Nexus knowledge assistant.

1. Annual leave entitlement

Every full-time employee receives 18 days of paid annual leave per completed calendar year. The entitlement is granted in full on 1 January and does not pro-rate for employees who joined during the year, except contractors who are not eligible for paid leave at all.

2. Carry forward

Up to 5 unused days of annual leave may be carried forward into the following calendar year. Carried-forward days must be used before 1 March of the following year, after which they expire. A maximum of 5 carried days may be accumulated across years.

3. Sick leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. A medical certificate is required for any absence of 3 consecutive working days or more. Unused sick leave cannot be carried forward and is not paid out on termination.

4. Parental leave

4.1 Maternity leave

Primary caregivers receive 26 weeks of fully paid maternity leave. Maternity leave may be taken in up to three separate blocks within the first 18 months after the birth or adoption of a child.

4.2 Paternity leave

Secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks of fully paid paternity leave, to be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption. Two additional weeks of unpaid paternity leave are available on request.

4.3 Parental leave for adoption and surrogacy

The same entitlements apply to adoption and surrogacy arrangements. Employees must notify People Operations at least 30 days before the expected date where reasonably practicable.

5. Unpaid leave

Employees may request unpaid leave of any duration. Requests longer than 4 weeks require approval from the department head and People Operations. Unpaid leave does not accrue annual leave and may affect variable pay.

6. Public holidays

Employees in the country of their employing entity observe the public holidays of that country. Where a public holiday falls on a weekend, the following Monday is observed.

7. Leave approval

All leave must be requested in the HR portal at least 5 working days before the requested start date. Approval is granted by the direct manager unless the leave exceeds 10 consecutive working days, in which case People Operations must also approve.

8. Leave during notice period

Unused annual leave may be taken during a notice period with manager approval. Leave already booked cannot be cancelled by the employee less than 2 weeks before it starts.

Questions about leave are answered by People Operations: people@northwind.example